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Revision Date:
August 1, 2026

Background:
State regulations require real and personal property, considered available to the CalWORKs family, to be evaluated towards the Assistance Unit's (AU) resource limit. An AU may retain countable resources in accordance with the established limits.

Purpose:
This section addresses regulations on determining the net market value for real property. The purpose of this material revision is for sunset review. There is no policy change.

Policy:
Net Market Value
Net market value for real property is determined by obtaining the current property tax statement identifying the market value (land value plus improvements value) and subtracting allowable encumbrances. Homeowner exemptions are not allowed against market value.

Real Property Market Value Verification
If a current tax statement is unavailable, market value can be verified by the following methods:

- Assessment Information – Obtained by calling the County Assessor office providing a name or address. Information that can be obtained includes:
  - Ownership.
  - Land value.
  - Improvements value.
  - Parcel number.
- Assessors Property System – Accessed through the selected Family Resource Center personnel.
- Tax Collector Information – Obtained by calling the County Tax Collector office and providing an address or parcel number, current taxes and a copy of the current tax bill, the following information can be obtained:
  - The assessed market value of the property.
  - Current taxes.
  - The document number of the recorded deed.
  - The date of recording.

Accepted phone verification must be documented in the case record with a Journal Entry (JE).

Out of county or state assessment information, if not available from customer documents, may usually be obtained by a phone call to the appropriate Assessor's office.

Encumbrance
Allowable encumbrances on real property include:

- Mortgages.
- Notes.
- Deeds of Trusts.

- Payment receipts.
- Loan payment balances.
- Delinquent tax liens.
- Mechanics liens.
- Assessments.
- Unpaid balance on property.
- Amount of aid paid during the nine-month exemption period.

Acceptable documentation of these encumbrances includes any document which states the current (within one year) encumbrance balance. Encumbrances do not include those incurred when the property is used as security for a loan to another party or those incurred on property interests of other parties in a joint tenancy.

Out-of-Country Property

Out-of-country property will be evaluated for availability. If the property meets the definition of availability, the net market value of the property must be determined from market values and encumbrances converted to dollar values. Exchange rates can be obtained from a newspaper, library or bank. If the required information is not available from documentation in the customer's possession, it will be necessary to contact the American Consulate closest to the property.

Procedure:
None.

Impacts:
Refer to CalFresh Program Guide (CFPG) 63-200 for CalFresh regulations related to resource evaluation.

References:
Manual of Policies and Procedures (MPP) 42-203.7.

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by July 31, 2029.

Approval for Release:

8/27/26

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